ANDRES HENAO

Cyber Security Specialist | Security Operations, Cloud & Network Security | AI Systems Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cyber security specialist with a Bachelor of Cyber Security from Victoria University (Distinction average) and practical experience securing AWS and Azure cloud environments, enterprise networks and production web applications. Strong foundation in security operations, vulnerability assessment, penetration testing and digital forensics, supported by knowledge of Australian and international cyber law, privacy regulation and professional ethics.

Combines security expertise with software and AI engineering, designing and operating AI-driven systems with security controls built in from the start, including WAF, bot detection, OAuth 2.1 and role-based access control. As founder of Awesome Services, led the adoption of AI and automation that improved operational accuracy by 90% and client retention by 96%, bringing more than a decade of business leadership to security decisions.

KEY SKILLS

Security Operations & Threat Detection: SIEM, Security Monitoring & Logging, Incident Response, Threat Analysis, Threat Intelligence, Intrusion & Anomaly Detection, Risk Assessment.

Vulnerability Management & Forensics: Vulnerability Assessment & Scanning, Penetration Testing, Ethical Hacking, API Security Testing, Digital Forensics (Memory, OS, Email, Network), Malware Analysis.

Cloud Security & Virtualisation: AWS (IAM, Cognito, Secrets Manager, Lambda, API Gateway, RDS, CloudWatch), Microsoft Azure, MFA, Key Management, PKI & mTLS, Docker, Kubernetes, Hyper-V, Infrastructure as Code, Serverless & Edge Computing, Disaster Recovery.

Network Security & Infrastructure: TCP/IP, Subnetting, IPv6, Routing & Switching (Cisco), LAN/WAN Design, Firewalls, VPN & IPSec, DNS, Group Policy, System Hardening, Linux & Server Administration.

Application Security & Identity: Web Application Firewall (WAF), Bot Detection, Rate Limiting, OAuth 2.1, SSO, Role-Based Access Control, Secrets Management, Secure API Design.

Governance, Privacy & Compliance: Cyber Law & Policy, Privacy Legislation, Data Masking & Privacy-Preserving Techniques, Security Policies & Standards, Professional Ethics, ICT Management.

AI Engineering & Automation: AI Agents, Multi-Provider LLM Integration, MCP Servers, Agentic Workflow Automation, AI-Assisted Development, System & API Design, PostgreSQL, CI/CD, Git & GitHub, Agile.

Scripting & Development: Python, TypeScript, SQL, Bash (working knowledge).

EDUCATION

Master of Applied Information Technology (In Progress)
Victoria University, Sydney, Australia | Sep 2026 - Expected 2028

Bachelor of Cyber Security
Victoria University, Sydney, Australia | 2023 - 2026
Graduated with a Distinction average (WAM 73.58, GPA 5.96 / 7.0). High Distinctions in IT Capstone Project 1 and 2, Cyber Security Essentials, Virtualisation in Computing, and Small IT Business.

Advanced Diploma of Leadership and Management
Australian Pacific College, Sydney, Australia | Aug 2016 - May 2018

Bachelor of International Trade and Logistics Management
Uninpahu University, Bogota, Colombia | Feb 2003 - Oct 2007

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

PitsyPet: AI Veterinary Triage | Full-Stack Engineer & AI Architect
AI triage platform for Australian pet owners that classifies symptom risk as Low, Medium or High using RAG over a veterinary knowledge base, with a deterministic safety override that can only escalate a result. Secured by Row Level Security on every table, five rate limiters, a fail-closed AI spend cap, nonce-based CSP and input validation, and verified by 180 automated tests. Built solo, calibrated with a veterinary surgeon, and live with Stripe subscriptions. (pitsypet.andreshenao.com.au)

The Watchtower | Security Engineer & AI Developer
Active-defence honeypot platform that fingerprints sessions, scores risk and detects bots in real time at the network edge, backed by a WAF and a fully serverless, edge-native security architecture. (sentinel.andreshenao.com.au)

Protegiendo Huellas Adoption Platform (Pro Bono) | Full-Stack Engineer & AI Architect
Adoption platform built as volunteer work for a dog rescue foundation in Colombia, live and in daily use. Includes a secure AI agent gateway over MCP and REST, with OAuth 2.1 and PKCE for assistants, revocable scoped keys for headless tools, separate read, edit and delete permissions, and an audit log of every agent call. Row Level Security is enforced as the final authority, and the platform is designed to run at zero hosting cost. (protegiendohuellas.org)

AI Billing Service | AI Systems Architect
Invoicing platform operated end to end by AI agents, reducing a full billing cycle to one message from a phone. Exposes 31 guarded tools over MCP and REST with OAuth 2.1 and per-agent keys, and enforces every financial rule (invoice numbering, GST, rate snapshots) inside PostgreSQL. In production for a real business. (billing.andreshenao.com.au)

Project Intelligence System | Full-Stack Engineer & AI Architect
Shared context layer for AI tools: a PostgreSQL database designed as the interface any AI assistant reads and writes through MCP, keeping 100% of project context across tool switches. (intel.andreshenao.com.au)

Personal Portfolio & AI Assistant | Full-Stack Engineer & Designer
Secure, AI-powered portfolio with a conversational assistant over a PostgreSQL database, protected by WAF middleware against automated bot threats. (cv.andreshenao.com.au)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Cyber Security Analyst Intern (Cloud Security)
Employability Advantage, supported by AusBiz Consulting, Australia | Nov 2025 - Mar 2026

- Secured AWS and Microsoft Azure environments over a 10-week cloud security engagement, remediating real-world vulnerabilities such as misconfigured storage, weak access controls and exposed APIs.
- Implemented identity and access controls with AWS IAM, Cognito, MFA and Secrets Manager, and provisioned RDS databases behind firewall rules.
- Secured APIs with Lambda, API Gateway and API key management, and applied key management and mTLS with digital certificates.
- Configured monitoring and logging in AWS CloudWatch and performed API and data-leak penetration testing to validate controls.
- Worked in an Agile team through GitHub, using GenAI tools to accelerate delivery and vulnerability testing.

Managing Director & Founder
Awesome Services, Sydney, Australia | Oct 2013 - Present

- Designed and deployed AI agents and Python automation workflows that improved operational accuracy by 90% and reduced administrative workload.
- Built and operate an AI-driven billing system that handles invoicing from a phone and generates tax reports on demand, with access controls and financial rules enforced at the database level.
- Introduced a customer service QA workflow that lifted client retention to 96%.
- Lead full business operations across multiple sites, including client acquisition, team building and training, quality and safety compliance, and financial management.

Logistics Specialist (Kemira Chemicals account)
Coordinadora Logistica Internacional, Bogota, Colombia | Jul 2008 - Mar 2013

- Served as in-house logistics specialist for Kemira Netherlands operations in Colombia, leading the design and implementation of a regional Logistics Support Warehouse (DAL) that reduced delivery times to Central American markets by over 50% and enabled new client acquisitions.
- Analysed shipping and warehouse data and built operational reports, improving on-time delivery, stock distribution, cost forecasting and carrier performance tracking.
- Coordinated national and international sea, air and overland freight in compliance with customs and safety regulations, and negotiated carrier rates and contracts that reduced transport costs.
- Led the rollout and training of a new logistics management system, improving tracking precision and warehouse efficiency across multiple sites.

Account Manager
Coordinadora Logistica Internacional, Bogota, Colombia | Feb 2006 - Jun 2008

- Managed national and international client accounts across multiple industries, delivering tailored logistics and supply chain solutions, and supported business development that brought in new international clients and expanded the service portfolio.
- Coordinated sea, air and overland transport in full compliance with international trade regulations, and negotiated contracts and freight rates with global carriers to reduce delivery costs and transit times.
- Oversaw daily operations across multiple warehouses, improving inventory accuracy, inbound and outbound scheduling and operational efficiency.
- Analysed logistics performance data to identify bottlenecks, improve KPIs and streamline end-to-end workflows.

Operations Specialist
Kuehne & Nagel, Bogota, Colombia | Feb 2005 - Jan 2006

- Oversaw international air, sea and land freight operations for major corporate clients, managing customs documentation, regulatory compliance and real-time tracking while optimising shipment coordination.
- Supported the rollout of the KN internal logistics tracking system, driving adoption through staff training and documentation and contributing to a 40% improvement in shipping data accuracy.
- Chaired the Occupational Health and Safety Committee, leading compliance initiatives and promoting workplace safety standards across the branch.

Customer Service Specialist
Kuehne & Nagel, Bogota, Colombia | Jan 2003 - Dec 2004

- Coordinated import and export operations for domestic and international clients as their primary liaison, ensuring shipment accuracy and timely delivery through proactive communication, real-time updates and issue resolution.
- Prepared and validated logistics and customs documentation in line with international shipping and trade regulations.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate
- IBM Full Stack Software Developer Specialization
- IBM Front-End Development Specialization
- IBM Back-End Development Specialization
- IBM Full-Stack JavaScript Developer Specialization
- IBM Developing AI Applications with Python and Flask
- IBM Python for Data Science, AI & Development
- TAFE NSW Introduction to Artificial Intelligence
- TAFE NSW Generative AI and its Business Applications
- TAFE NSW Responsible Artificial Intelligence